

Where Are the Jellyfish?

Jellyfish populations have been increasing in recent years, driven by rising ocean temperatures due to climate change. These blooms alter marine ecosystems by competing with native predators for plankton and disrupt coastal industries by destroying aquaculture stocks and clogging industrial cooling systems¹. The southwest coast of the UK, particularly Cornwall and Devon, has experienced some of the strongest recent jellyfish bloom activity².

This map shows the jellyfish sightings within 20 km of the southwest UK region from 2015 to 2025. Clusters indicate areas where at least 10 sightings of the same species occur within 5 km of each other, while remaining records are shown as isolated sightings. The largest clusters are labelled with the most dominant species within the cluster.

